

IT-SEP1 case, autumn 2025

Green Bob is the coordinator and eco-philosopher of the ecological village Cloverville, where 42 people live sustainably, grow their own vegetables, and share everything from egg cartons to avocado trees. Bob now seeks help in managing the 'invisible work' that sustains the village - all the green actions and services contributed by its members. This is where we as a development team comes in.



The interview

Us: Hello Mr. We've heard that you need a system to keep track of the green activities in the village.

Green Bob: No need to be formal - just call me Bob, or Green Bob as they call me around here. And yes, green initiatives are flowing - people are cycling, composting, and brewing nettle tea like never before. I want to document it, and my worn-out notebook is no longer enough.

Us: So, you want to record activities and see who contributes?

Green Bob: Exactly - green and individual actions, communal tasks, and trade offers, all can be seen as different kinds of activities - and of course, our point system.

Us: Can you tell us a bit about these different types of activities?

Green Bob: Sure. Green actions are things you do on your own to promote a sustainable lifestyle, and they don't directly affect others in Cloverville. For example, cycling to work for a whole week, eating vegan for a week, switching to energy-efficient lighting, and so on. We want to record those so people are encouraged to continue, and others can be inspired by the ideas. Green actions should be shown without names to work as a catalogue of inspiration - so everyone can see what's possible, without it feeling like a competition.

Us: So, you want to record these and show a catalogue of ideas?

Green Bob: Exactly! You got it. I want to register green points for each of these actions, so points are added to a shared pool - like a kind of 'climate capital' we all build together. And as you said, it also provides inspiration. People can see what others have done and get ideas.

Us: You also mentioned communal and trade tasks - can you describe those?

Green Bob: Yes, absolutely. In Cloverville, there are several shared tasks - like preparing food for communal dinners, tidying the workshop, taking care of the shared outdoor areas, or garden duties. It would be great if participants could receive personal points for these tasks.

Us: Are those the same points as for green actions?

Green Bob: No, these are personal points from communal tasks. This way, we can keep things fair with shared duties, and also motivate others to participate.

Us: How do you assign points to tasks?

Green Bob: Recurring tasks should always give the same amount of personal points, so everyone knows the value. New tasks can be estimated. I don't really know - it has to be a free community, without competition or pressure, where everything is good. Maybe we can give a boost to those who rarely participate - like 10-30%

extra points for the same task. I'm open to suggestions! Either way, the personal points should be usable for trade offers.

Us: Are trade offers like purchases using points?

Green Bob: I hadn't thought of it that way, but yes, that makes sense. Trade offers are where people offer goods or services - like using some of your personal points to get your windows cleaned, or get Hetty to mend your pants, or me to offer a guided meditation. It could also be things like carrots or a compost bin. We've previously just swapped things one-for-one, but the point system might make it easier. There could also be a pool of available trade offers to choose from. And while we're dreaming, maybe we reset the personal points periodically, so no one becomes a 'point king', and instead they either use them for trade offers or let them roll into the community pool.

Us: And how would you like to use the community points - just for motivation?

Green Bob: The green points... I'm not entirely sure - they're more for inspiration. Both for us in Cloverville and other communities, to live more sustainably together and alone. When we reach a certain threshold, we could unlock something special - like building a rainwater collector, hosting a pizza night, buying a new communal wheelbarrow, or something even wilder.

Us: So, we're talking about registering three types of activities, two types of points, reports showing inspirational actions, and reports showing available trade tasks. We can handle that. Any specific requirements for the implementation? We mostly use Java.

Green Bob: I'm more of a herbal tea guy.

Us: Right... It's absolutely possible to create a system where everyone can report their tasks. Would you also like to show something on a website?

Green Bob: Oops! Actually, only me - and maybe Don - should use the program to manage residents, tasks, points, and such. The program should only be on my computer, and people must come to me to get their activities registered. But having a website would be brilliant! That way, I won't need to print everything and hang it up. Everyone can see the green point account, the week's green focus tasks, and the available trade offers. And if others find the site, they can read about us, see what we're doing, and hopefully adopt some of our ideas.

Us: Sounds like something we can build. Anything else you'd like to include?

Green Bob: Yes, we're a green community that values sustainability and ecology. Maybe you can consider how to code it as efficiently as possible - you know, use as little energy as you can.

Us: Uh, yes - we'll do that. Thanks for your time - we'll begin the requirement analysis now.

Green Bob: Thank you very much - I look forward to seeing your ideas for the system!